

ports of the interface. Traffic can be inbound or outbound. When data is sent to a user's PC, it is inbound traffic, and when the user's PC is sending data, it is outbound traffic. Usually, inbound traffic is considered more dangerous since it could be a virus or Trojan trying to gain access into the system. But outbound traffic can also be harmful, since it could be an application that is surreptitiously passing data to someone else—for example, a keylogger could be operational.

5.5.2 Comodo Personal Firewall

CPF has won rave reviews that pretty much say it's better than most other personal firewalls, free or paid.

After installation, a Wizard helps you configure CPF. While the automatic configuration works well, you can also manually change parameters—like designating which network device is used to connect to the Net, which applications are considered trusted, and the frequency with



The Summary window in Comodo Personal Firewall

which CPF should alert you. CPF maintains a database of trusted applications that should be allowed access to the Net; you can either prefer to go with the database, or scan your system for applications and mark them as trusted or otherwise.

Depending on the Alert frequency set during the configuration, CPF will pop up alerts whenever an application tries to access the Net, asking you whether it should allow or deny access. Besides the Application, Component, and Network monitors, which watch installed programs, OS components, and the network interface respectively, CPF also has an Application Behaviour Analysis module. This is a technique employed by CPF to identify malware by analysing their behaviour. This module can identify attempts by certain applications to launch other applications, for example,